

4.1 English in the world

Paper 4 Language Topics · 2026 examination · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

World Englishes vary in pronunciation, vocabulary and grammar through contact and local identity. Describe a variety in its own systematic context instead of ranking it against one national “standard”. Language policy, education, media and multilingualism affect use. Distinguish an evidence-based description from stereotype.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

A borrowed local food word in an English news report can make a local audience feel addressed while still serving an international audience through context clues.

Original practice stimulus

A local newspaper reports: “The evening market opened with bowls of laksa at every stall; laksa is a spiced noodle dish served in many styles across the region. Organisers said the event welcomed both neighbours and visitors.” In the same edition, a headline uses an English expression familiar to national readers and the article quotes a vendor in a local language with an English translation. The editor explains in a note that some words are left untranslated when a nearby sentence supplies enough context. This is one edited news article, not a transcript of ordinary speech across the country.

Extended response

Compose your response in the space provided and support your interpretation with evidence.

1 Dataset: a local newspaper retains an untranslated food name, then glosses it in English. Analyse two reasons for this choice and one risk of treating this sample as typical of a whole country.

[25]

Check: relevant evidence · coherent argument · accurate and deliberate language

Answers and explanation

Question 1 [25 marks]

A strong answer connects lexical borrowing to identity and glossing to wider accessibility; evaluates audience/genre; notes a single edited text cannot represent all speakers or varieties. Use observations before broad claims.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or calculation error; then retry without looking at the solution.

Syllabus: English Language 9093, 2024–2026.
<https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/635901-2024-2026-syllabus.pdf>

Original FagusED teaching material. Question layout and mark presentation informed by the May/June 2026 papers supplied by the user. The practice question is newly written and is not a Cambridge past-paper question.